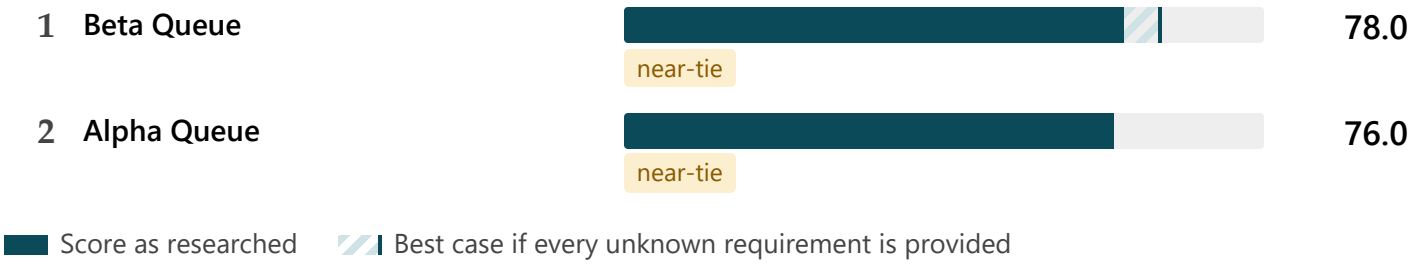
background task queue

Evaluation date **2026-10-01** Report date **2026-10-02** Scale **0 to 5** Cost mode **weighted**

Recommendation and notes Decision table Criteria and weights Bias and assumption checks
Weighted score matrix Feature-by-feature comparison Cost: total cost of ownership Sensitivity
Excluded options Sources

Beta Queue scores 78.0 of 100, 2.0 ahead of Alpha Queue.

The ranking is not settled: the lead is inside the near-tie margin.



Recommendation and notes

> Recommendation: the choice between Beta Queue and Alpha Queue is not clear-cut (78.0 against 76.0, inside the 3-point tie margin). Beta Queue leads on core capabilities, but its operability claims are unverified, and lowering those low-confidence scores puts Alpha Queue ahead. Verify the metrics support of Beta Queue before committing.
>
> See `scores.json` and `features.md` for the full numbers. Gamma Queue was excluded because it fails the delivery gate (E-010).

Decision table

Rank	Option	Weighted score (of 100)	Low-confidence criteria	Must-have gaps	Unknown requirements	Best cas
1	Beta Queue (near-tie)	78.0	1	1	0	
2	Alpha Queue (near-tie)	76.0	0	1	0	

Near-tie between Beta Queue, Alpha Queue; broken by higher score on highest-weight criterion.

Criteria and weights

Criterion	Weight	Requirements
Core capabilities	50	F-01, F-02
Operability	30	N-01, N-02
Cost	20	C-01, C-02

Bias and assumption checks

- No requirement is marked as an assumption.
- Findings by source: Alpha Queue: 1 vendor, 4 independent or open source; Beta Queue: 1 vendor, 3 independent or open source.
- Cost compares 2 of 2 options; the others have no published price.

Weighted score matrix

Criterion	Weight	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue
Core capabilities	50	5 high	4 high
Operability	30	2† low	4 medium
Cost	20	4 medium	3 medium
Weighted total	**100**	**78.0**	**76.0**

† score capped because the evidence is unverified. Confidence: high = two sources, medium = one, low = none. Independent sources count, and the vendor's official documentation counts once for what a product provides.

Feature-by-feature comparison

Core

ID	Requirement	Priority	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue
F-01	At-least-once delivery of jobs	must	provided [E-006]	provided [E-001]
F-02	Delayed and scheduled jobs	should	provided [E-007]	partial - no recurring schedules [E-002]

Operations

ID	Requirement	Priority	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue
N-01	Metrics and health endpoints for monitoring	must	partial - via plugin, vendor claim only [E-008]	provided [E-003]
N-02	Web dashboard for inspecting jobs	could	provided [E-008]	not provided - no dashboard found

Cost

ID	Requirement	Priority	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue
C-01	Predictable pricing at 5 million jobs per month	must	provided - self-hosted [E-009]	partial - tiered, volume discount [E-004]

ID	Requirement	Priority	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue
C-02	A usable free tier for development	should	partial - no hosted free tier	provided - 100k jobs free [E-005]

Cost: total cost of ownership

Over 36 months, in USD. Prices come from the sources listed below; components marked unverified rest on weak evidence, and components marked assumed are placeholders, not published prices.

Assumption	Value	Unit	Scales in scenarios
Jobs per month	5,000,000	jobs/month	yes
Developers	4	people	no

Option	Monthly	One-time	Total over horizon	Vs cheapest	Notes
Beta Queue	380.00	2,000.00	15,680.00	1.00x	unverified: b-plugin
Alpha Queue	1,260.00	0.00	45,360.00	2.89x	

Volume scenarios

Scenario	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue	Cheapest
pilot (100k jobs/month)	15,680.00	3,600.00	Alpha Queue
growth (10M jobs/month)	15,680.00	81,360.00	Beta Queue

Components

Option	Component	Monthly	One-time	Evidence
Beta Queue	Hosting (2 nodes)	300.00	0.00	
Beta Queue	Monitoring plugin	80.00	0.00	unverified
Beta Queue	Initial setup	0.00	2,000.00	
Alpha Queue	Job volume	1,160.00	0.00	
Alpha Queue	Support plan	100.00	0.00	

Sensitivity

Each of the highest-weight criteria moved by 5 points, other weights rescaled.

Criterion	Change	Top option	Top changed	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue
Core capabilities	+5	Beta Queue	no	80.2	76.4
Core capabilities	-5	Beta Queue	no	75.8	75.6
Operability	+5	Beta Queue	no	75.3	76.3
Operability	-5	Beta Queue	no	80.7	75.7
Cost	+5	Beta Queue	no	78.1	75.0
Cost	-5	Beta Queue	no	77.9	77.0

Confidence tests

Test	Top option	Top changed
all low-confidence scores lowered by one	Alpha Queue	yes
Beta Queue / Operability lowered by one	Alpha Queue	yes

Excluded options

Option	Reason
Gamma Queue	Fails F-01: no at-least-once delivery (E-010)

Sources

ID	Option	Requirement	Finding	Source	Source date	Confidence	Kind
E-001	Alpha Queue	F-01	Delivers at least once under failure injection	https://bench.example.org/alpha	2026-08-01	CONFIRMED	independent

ID	Option	Requirement	Finding	Source	Source date	Confidence	Kind
E-002	Alpha Queue	F-02	Delayed jobs supported, recurring schedules are not	https://review.example.net/alpha	2026-07-15	PROBABLE	independent
E-003	Alpha Queue	N-01	Exposes Prometheus metrics and a health endpoint	https://review.example.net/alpha	2026-07-15	PROBABLE	independent
E-004	Alpha Queue	C-01	Tiered pricing with a volume discount above 1M jobs	https://alpha.example.com/pricing	2026-09-01	PRIMARY	vendor
E-005	Alpha Queue	C-02	Free tier of 100k jobs per month	https://bench.example.org/alpha	2026-08-01	PROBABLE	independent
E-006	Beta Queue	F-01	At-least-once delivery confirmed in tests	https://bench.example.org/beta	2026-08-01	CONFIRMED	independent
E-007	Beta Queue	F-02	Delayed and recurring jobs supported	https://docs-mirror.example.net/beta	2026-06-20	PROBABLE	independent
E-008	Beta Queue	N-01	Vendor says metrics are available through a plugin	https://beta.example.com/docs/ops	2026-09-10	UNVERIFIED	vendor
E-009	Beta Queue	C-01	Open source; hosting cost is predictable	https://review.example.net/beta	2026-07-15	PROBABLE	independent
E-010	Gamma Queue	F-01	At-most-once delivery only	https://bench.example.org/gamma	2026-08-01	CONFIRMED	independent